
The Recent Past and Near Future of Risk and/or Need Assessment

Item Type Journal Article
Author D. A. Andrews
Author James Bonta
Author J. Stephen Wormith
Date 2006-01-01
Language EN
Library Catalog SAGE Journals
URL <https://doi.org/10.1177/0011128705281756>
Accessed 6/26/2026, 2:39:53 PM
Extra Publisher: SAGE Publications Inc
Volume 52
Pages 7-27
Publication Crime & Delinquency
DOI 10.1177/0011128705281756
Issue 1
ISSN 0011-1287
Date Added 6/26/2026, 2:39:53 PM
Modified 6/26/2026, 2:39:53 PM

Attachments

- SAGE PDF Full Text

Machine Bias

Item Type Journal Article
Author Julia Anguin
Author Jeff Larsen
Abstract There's software used across the country to predict future criminals. And it's biased against blacks.
Date May 23, 2016
Language en
Accessed 11/4/2023, 11:49:23 AM
Publication ProPublica
Date Added 11/4/2023, 11:49:23 AM
Modified 11/26/2023, 1:43:56 PM

Attachments

- Snapshot

Fair Prediction with Disparate Impact: A Study of Bias in Recidivism Prediction Instruments

Item Type Journal Article
Author Alexandra Chouldechova
Abstract Recidivism prediction instruments (RPIs) provide decision-makers with an assessment of the likelihood that a criminal defendant will reoffend at a future point in time. Although such instruments are gaining increasing popularity across the country, their use is attracting tremendous controversy. Much of the controversy concerns potential discriminatory bias in the risk assessments that are produced. This article discusses several fairness criteria that have recently been applied to assess the fairness of RPIs. We demonstrate that the criteria cannot all be simultaneously satisfied when recidivism prevalence differs across groups. We then show how disparate impact can arise when an RPI fails to satisfy the criterion of error rate balance.
Date 2017-06-01
Language EN
Short Title Fair Prediction with Disparate Impact
Library Catalog SAGE Journals
URL <https://journals.sagepub.com/action/showAbstract>
Accessed 6/26/2026, 2:41:22 PM
Extra Publisher: SAGE Publications
Volume 5
Pages 153-163
Publication Big Data
DOI 10.1089/big.2016.0047
Issue 2
ISSN 2167-6461
Date Added 6/26/2026, 2:41:22 PM
Modified 6/26/2026, 2:41:22 PM

Attachments

- Submitted Version

Use and Misuse of the Receiver Operating Characteristic Curve in Risk Prediction

Item Type Journal Article
Author Nancy R. Cook
Abstract The c statistic, or area under the receiver operating characteristic (ROC) curve, achieved popularity in diagnostic testing, in which the test characteristics of sensitivity and specificity are relevant to discriminating diseased versus nondiseased patients. The c statistic, however, may not be optimal in assessing models that predict future risk or stratify individuals into risk categories. In this setting, calibration is as important to the accurate assessment of risk. For example, a biomarker with an odds ratio of 3 may have little effect on the c statistic, yet an increased level could shift estimated 10-year cardiovascular risk for an individual patient from 8% to 24%, which would lead to different treatment recommendations under current Adult Treatment Panel III guidelines. Accepted risk factors such as lipids, hypertension, and smoking have only marginal impact on the c statistic individually yet lead to more accurate reclassification of large proportions of patients into higher-risk or lower-risk categories. Perfectly calibrated models for complex disease can, in fact, only achieve values for the c statistic well below the theoretical maximum of 1. Use of the c statistic for model selection could thus naively eliminate established risk factors from cardiovascular risk prediction scores. As novel risk factors are discovered, sole reliance on the c statistic to evaluate their utility as risk predictors thus seems ill-advised.
Date 2007-02-20
Library Catalog ahajournals.org (Atypon)
URL <https://www.ahajournals.org/doi/full/10.1161/CIRCULATIONAHA.106.672402>
Accessed 9/20/2026, 2:05:02 PM
Volume 115
Publisher American Heart Association
Pages 928-935
Publication Circulation
DOI 10.1161/CIRCULATIONAHA.106.672402
Issue 7
Date Added 9/20/2026, 2:05:02 PM
Modified 9/20/2026, 2:05:02 PM

Attachments

- Full Text PDF

Clinical Versus Actuarial Judgment

Item Type Journal Article
Author Robyn M. Dawes
Author David Faust
Author Paul E. Meehl
Date 1989
Language en
Library Catalog Zotero
Volume 243
Pages 1668-1674
Publication Science, New Series
Issue 4899
Date Added 9/17/2023, 3:47:49 PM
Modified 11/26/2023, 1:45:49 PM

Attachments

- Dawes et al. - 1989 - Clinical Versus Actuarial Judgment.pdf

Trial by Statistics: Is a High Probability of Guilt Enough to Convict?

Item Type Journal Article
Author Marcello Di Bello
Abstract Suppose one hundred prisoners are in a yard under the supervision of a guard, and at some point, ninety-nine of them collectively kill the guard. If, after the fact, a prisoner is picked at random and tried, the probability of his guilt is 99%. But despite the high probability, the statistical chances, by themselves, seem insufficient to justify a conviction. The question is why. Two arguments are offered. The first, decision-theoretic argument shows that a conviction solely based on the statistics in the prisoner scenario is unacceptable so long as the goal of expected utility maximization is combined with fairness constraints. The second, risk-based argument shows that a conviction solely based on the statistics in the prisoner scenario lets the risk of mistaken conviction surge potentially too high. The same, by contrast, cannot be said of convictions solely based on DNA evidence or eyewitness testimony. A noteworthy feature of the two arguments in the paper is that they are not confined to criminal trials and can in fact be extended to civil trials.
Date 2019-10-01
Short Title Trial by Statistics
Library Catalog Silverchair
URL <https://doi.org/10.1093/mind/fzy026>
Accessed 9/22/2026, 3:02:11 PM
Volume 128
Pages 1045-1084
Publication Mind
DOI 10.1093/mind/fzy026
Issue 512
Journal Abbr Mind
ISSN 0026-4423
Date Added 9/22/2026, 3:02:11 PM

Modified 9/22/2026, 3:02:11 PM

When statistical evidence is not specific enough

Item Type Journal Article
Author Marcello Di Bello
Abstract Many philosophers have pointed out that statistical evidence, or at least some forms of it, lack desirable epistemic or non-epistemic properties, and that this should make us wary of litigations in which the case against the defendant rests in whole or in part on statistical evidence. Others have responded that such broad reservations about statistical evidence are overly restrictive since appellate courts have expressed nuanced views about statistical evidence. In an effort to clarify and reconcile, I put forward an interpretive analysis of why statistical evidence should raise concerns in some cases but not others. I argue that when there is a mismatch between the specificity of the evidence and the expected specificity of the accusation, statistical evidence—as any other kind of evidence—should be considered insufficient to sustain a conviction. I rely on different stylized court cases to illustrate the explanatory power of this analysis.
Date 2021-12-01
Language en
Library Catalog Springer Link
URL <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11229-021-03331-0>
Accessed 9/22/2026, 3:02:58 PM
Volume 199
Pages 12251-12269
Publication Synthese
DOI 10.1007/s11229-021-03331-0
Issue 5
Journal Abbr Synthese
ISSN 1573-0964
Date Added 9/22/2026, 3:02:58 PM
Modified 9/22/2026, 3:02:58 PM

Tags:

Criminal trials, Decision, Eyewitness testimony, Naked statistical evidence, Probability, Specificity, Standards of proof

Attachments

- Full Text PDF

Informational richness and its impact on algorithmic fairness

Item Type Journal Article
Author Marcello Di Bello
Author Ruobin Gong
Abstract The literature on algorithmic fairness has examined exogenous sources of biases such as shortcomings in the data and structural injustices in society. It has also examined internal sources of bias as evidenced by a number of impossibility theorems showing that no algorithm can concurrently satisfy multiple criteria of fairness. This paper contributes to the literature stemming from the impossibility theorems by examining how informational richness affects the accuracy and fairness of predictive algorithms. With the aid of a computer simulation, we show that informational richness is the engine that drives improvements in the performance of a predictive algorithm, in terms of both accuracy and fairness. The centrality of informational richness suggests that classification parity, a popular criterion of algorithmic fairness, should be given relatively little weight. But we caution that the centrality of informational richness should be taken with a grain of salt in light of practical limitations, in particular, the so-called bias-variance trade off.
Date 2025-01-01
Language en
Library Catalog Springer Link
URL <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11098-023-02004-7>
Accessed 9/22/2026, 3:02:30 PM
Volume 182
Pages 25-53
Publication Philosophical Studies
DOI 10.1007/s11098-023-02004-7
Issue 1
Journal Abbr Philos Stud
ISSN 1573-0883
Date Added 9/22/2026, 3:02:30 PM
Modified 9/22/2026, 3:02:30 PM

Tags:

Algorithmic fairness, Bias-variance trade off, Classification parity, Computer simulation, Conscientiousness, Impossibility theorems, Informational richness, Predictive parity

Attachments

- Full Text PDF

Evidential Reasoning

Item Type Book Section
Author Marcello Di Bello
Author Bart Verheij

Editor Giorgio Bongiovanni
Editor Gerald Postema
Editor Antonino Rotolo
Editor Giovanni Sartor
Editor Chiara Valentini
Editor Douglas Walton
Abstract When a suspect appears in front of a criminal court, there is a high probability that he will be found guilty. In the USA, statistics for recent years show that the conviction rate in federal courts is roughly 90%, and in Japan reaches as high a rate as 99%.
Date 2018
Language en
Library Catalog Springer Link
URL https://doi.org/10.1007/978-90-481-9452-0_16
Accessed 9/22/2026, 3:02:26 PM
Place Dordrecht
Publisher Springer Netherlands
ISBN 978-90-481-9452-0
Pages 447-493
Book Title Handbook of Legal Reasoning and Argumentation
DOI 10.1007/978-90-481-9452-0_16
Date Added 9/22/2026, 3:02:26 PM
Modified 9/22/2026, 3:02:26 PM

Classification Parity, Causal Equal Protection and Algorithmic Fairness: 2nd European Workshop on Algorithmic Fairness, EWAF 2023

Item Type Journal Article
Author Marcello Di Bello
Author Nicolò Cangiotti
Author Michele Loi
Date 2023
Short Title Classification Parity, Causal Equal Protection and Algorithmic Fairness
Library Catalog Arizona State University
URL <https://www.scopus.com/pages/publications/85168347911>
Accessed 9/22/2026, 3:03:30 PM
Volume 3442
Publication CEUR Workshop Proceedings
ISSN 1613-0073
Date Added 9/22/2026, 3:03:30 PM
Modified 9/22/2026, 3:03:30 PM

Tags:

Algorithmic Fairness, Classification parity, Counterfactual Fairness, Diagnostic Evidence, Equal protection, Statistical Profile

False Positives, False Negatives, and False Analyses: A Rejoinder to Machine Bias: There

Item Type Journal Article
Author Anthony W. Flores
Author Kristin Bechtel
Author Christopher T. Lowenkamp
Date 2016
Short Title False Positives, False Negatives, and False Analyses
Library Catalog COinS
Extra Context Object:
ctx_ver=Z39.88-2004&rft_val_fmt=info%3Aofi%2Ffmt%3Akev%3Amtx%3Ajournal&rft_id=info%3Aasid%2Focoins.info%3Agenerator&rft.genre=article&rft.atitle=False Positives, False Negatives, and False Analyses: A Rejoinder to Machine Bias: There
Volume 80
Publication Federal Probation
Issue 2
Date Added 6/26/2026, 3:58:55 PM
Modified 6/26/2026, 3:59:51 PM

Methodological advances in statistical prediction.

Item Type Journal Article
Author Howard N. Garb
Author James M. Wood
Date 12/2019
Language en
Library Catalog DOL.org (Crossref)
Accessed 11/5/2023, 11:56:43 AM
Volume 31
Pages 1456-1466

Publication Psychological Assessment
DOI 10.1037/pas0000673
Issue 12
Journal Abbr Psychological Assessment
ISSN 1939-134X, 1040-3590
Date Added 11/5/2023, 11:56:43 AM
Modified 11/26/2023, 1:43:43 PM

Attachments

- Garb and Wood - 2019 - Methodological advances in statistical prediction..pdf

Race and Wrongful Convictions in the United States

Item Type Journal Article
Author Samuel Gross
Author Maurice Possley
Author Klara Stephens
Date 2017-03-07
Library Catalog COinS
URL <https://repository.law.umich.edu/other/122>
Publication Other Publications
Date Added 7/1/2026, 1:58:41 PM
Modified 7/1/2026, 1:58:41 PM

Attachments

- text/html Attachment

Clinical versus mechanical prediction: A meta-analysis

Item Type Journal Article
Author William M. Grove
Author David H. Zald
Author Boyd S. Lebow
Author Beth E. Snitz
Author Chad Nelson
Abstract The process of making judgments and decisions requires a method for combining data. To compare the accuracy of clinical and mechanical (formal, statistical) data-combination techniques, we performed a meta-analysis on studies of human health and behavior. On average, mechanical-prediction techniques were about 10% more accurate than clinical predictions. Depending on the specific analysis, mechanical prediction substantially outperformed clinical prediction in 33%–47% of studies examined. Although clinical predictions were often as accurate as mechanical predictions, in only a few studies (6%–16%) were they substantially more accurate. Superiority for mechanical-prediction techniques was consistent, regardless of the judgment task, type of judges, judges' amounts of experience, or the types of data being combined. Clinical predictions performed relatively less well when predictors included clinical interview data. These data indicate that mechanical predictions of human behaviors are equal or superior to clinical prediction methods for a wide range of circumstances. (PsycInfo Database Record (c) 2025 APA, all rights reserved)
Date 2000
Short Title Clinical versus mechanical prediction
Library Catalog APA PsycNet
Extra Place: US Publisher: American Psychological Association
Volume 12
Pages 19-30
Publication Psychological Assessment
DOI 10.1037/1040-3590.12.1.19
Issue 1
ISSN 1939-134X
Date Added 6/26/2026, 2:40:11 PM
Modified 6/26/2026, 2:40:11 PM

Tags:

Health, Behavior, Statistical Measurement, Prediction, Clinical Judgment (Not Diagnosis)

Attachments

- Full Text PDF

The accuracy of recidivism risk assessments for sexual offenders: A meta-analysis of 118 prediction studies

Item Type Journal Article
Author R. Karl Hanson
Author Kelly E. Morton-Bourgon
Abstract This review compared the accuracy of various approaches to the prediction of recidivism among sexual offenders. On the basis of a meta-analysis of 536 findings drawn from 118 distinct samples (45,398 sexual offenders, 16 countries), empirically derived actuarial measures were more accurate than unstructured professional judgment for all outcomes (sexual, violent, or any recidivism). The accuracy of structured professional judgment was intermediate between the accuracy found for the actuarial measures and for unstructured professional judgment. The effect sizes for the actuarial measures were moderate to large by

conventional standards (average d values of 0.67–0.97); however, the utility of the actuarial measures will vary according to the referral question and samples assessed. Further research should identify the psychologically meaningful factors that contribute to risk for reoffending. (PsycInfo Database Record (c) 2025 APA, all rights reserved)

Date 2009
Short Title The accuracy of recidivism risk assessments for sexual offenders
Library Catalog APA PsycNet
Extra Place: US Publisher: American Psychological Association
Volume 21
Pages 1-21
Publication Psychological Assessment
DOI 10.1037/a0014421
Issue 1
ISSN 1939-134X
Date Added 6/26/2026, 2:40:07 PM
Modified 6/26/2026, 2:40:07 PM

Tags:

Judgment, Risk Assessment, Recidivism, Criminal Offenders, Sex Offenses, Sexual Offenders

Attachments

- Full Text PDF

Risk as a Proxy for Race: The Dangers of Risk Assessment

Item Type Journal Article
Author Bernard E. Harcourt
Date 2015
Short Title Risk as a Proxy for Race
Library Catalog JSTOR
URL <https://www.jstor.org/stable/10.1525/fsr.2015.27.4.237>
Accessed 8/14/2026, 5:48:53 PM
Extra Publisher: [University of California Press, Vera Institute of Justice]
Volume 27
Pages 237-243
Publication Federal Sentencing Reporter
DOI 10.1525/fsr.2015.27.4.237
Issue 4
ISSN 1053-9867
Date Added 8/14/2026, 5:48:53 PM
Modified 8/14/2026, 5:48:53 PM

Attachments

- JSTOR Full Text PDF

Residual Unfairness in Fair Machine Learning from Prejudiced Data

Item Type Conference Paper
Author Nathan Kallus
Author Angela Zhou
Abstract Recent work in fairness in machine learning has proposed adjusting for fairness by equalizing accuracy metrics across groups and has also studied how datasets affected by historical prejudices may lead to unfair decision policies. We connect these lines of work and study the residual unfairness that arises when a fairness-adjusted predictor is not actually fair on the target population due to systematic censoring of training data by existing biased policies. This scenario is particularly common in the same applications where fairness is a concern. We characterize theoretically the impact of such censoring on standard fairness metrics for binary classifiers and provide criteria for when residual unfairness may or may not appear. We prove that, under certain conditions, fairness-adjusted classifiers will in fact induce residual unfairness that perpetuates the same injustices, against the same groups, that biased the data to begin with, thus showing that even state-of-the-art fair machine learning can have a "bias in, bias out" property. When certain benchmark data is available, we show how sample reweighting can estimate and adjust fairness metrics while accounting for censoring. We use this to study the case of Stop, Question, and Frisk (SQF) and demonstrate that attempting to adjust for fairness perpetuates the same injustices that the policy is infamous for.
Date 2018-07-03
Language en
Library Catalog proceedings.mlr.press
URL <https://proceedings.mlr.press/v80/kallus18a.html>
Accessed 6/26/2026, 2:41:06 PM
Extra ISSN: 2640-3498
Publisher PMLR
Pages 2439-2448
Proceedings Title Proceedings of the 35th International Conference on Machine Learning
Conference Name International Conference on Machine Learning
Date Added 6/26/2026, 2:41:06 PM
Modified 6/26/2026, 2:41:06 PM

Attachments

- Full Text PDF
- Supplementary PDF

Inherent Trade-Offs in the Fair Determination of Risk Scores

Item Type	Preprint
Author	Jon Kleinberg
Author	Sendhil Mullainathan
Author	Manish Raghavan
Abstract	Recent discussion in the public sphere about algorithmic classification has involved tension between competing notions of what it means for a probabilistic classification to be fair to different groups. We formalize three fairness conditions that lie at the heart of these debates, and we prove that except in highly constrained special cases, there is no method that can satisfy these three conditions simultaneously. Moreover, even satisfying all three conditions approximately requires that the data lie in an approximate version of one of the constrained special cases identified by our theorem. These results suggest some of the ways in which key notions of fairness are incompatible with each other, and hence provide a framework for thinking about the trade-offs between them.
Date	2016-11-17
Library Catalog	arXiv.org
URL	http://arxiv.org/abs/1609.05807
Accessed	6/26/2026, 2:41:15 PM
Extra	arXiv:1609.05807 [cs.LG]
DOI	10.48550/arXiv.1609.05807
Repository	arXiv
Archive ID	arXiv:1609.05807
Date Added	6/26/2026, 2:41:15 PM
Modified	6/26/2026, 2:41:15 PM

Tags:

Computer Science - Computers and Society, Computer Science - Machine Learning, Statistics - Machine Learning

Notes:

Comment: To appear in Proceedings of Innovations in Theoretical Computer Science (ITCS), 2017

Attachments

- Preprint PDF
- Snapshot

How We Analyzed the COMPAS Recidivism Algorithm

Item Type	Journal Article
Author	Jeff Larsen
Author	Suya Mattu
Author	Julia Anguin
Abstract	ProPublica is an independent, non-profit newsroom that produces investigative journalism in the public interest.
Date	May 23, 2016
Language	en
Accessed	11/4/2023, 11:49:59 AM
Publication	ProPublica
Date Added	11/4/2023, 11:49:59 AM
Modified	11/26/2023, 1:43:52 PM

Attachments

- Snapshot

Clinical versus statistical prediction: A theoretical analysis and a review of the evidence

Item Type	Book
Author	Paul E. Meehl
Abstract	This monograph is an expansion of lectures given in the years 1947-1950 to graduate colloquia at the universities of Chicago, Iowa, and Wisconsin, and of a lecture series delivered to staff and trainees at the Veterans Administration Mental Hygiene Clinic at Ft. Snelling, Minnesota. Perhaps a general remark in clarification of my own position is in order. Students in my class in clinical psychology have often reacted to the lectures on this topic as to a protective technique, complaining that I was biased either for or against statistics (or the clinician), depending mainly on where the student himself stood! This I have, of course, found very reassuring. One clinical student suggested that I tally the pro-con ratio for the list of honorific and derogatory adjectives in Chapter 1 (page 4), and the reader will discover that this unedited sample of my verbal behavior puts my bias squarely at the midline. The style and sequence of the paper reflect my own ambivalence and real puzzlement, and I have deliberately left the document in this discursive form to retain the flavor of the mental conflict that besets most of us who do clinical work but try to be scientists. I have read and heard too many rapid-fire, once-over-lightly "resolutions" of this controversy to aim at contributing another such. The thing is just not that simple. I was therefore not surprised to discover that the same sections which one reader finds obvious and over-elaborated, another singles out as especially useful for his particular difficulties. My thesis in a nutshell: "There is no convincing reason to assume that explicitly formalized mathematical rules and the clinician's creativity are equally suited for any given kind of task, or that their comparative effectiveness is the same for different tasks. Current clinical practice should be much more critically examined with this in mind than it has been." (PsycInfo Database Record (c) 2025 APA, all rights reserved)
Date	1954
Short Title	Clinical versus statistical prediction

Library Catalog APA PsycNet
Extra DOI: 10.1037/11281-000 Pages: x, 149
Place Minneapolis, MN, US
Publisher University of Minnesota Press
Series Clinical versus statistical prediction: A theoretical analysis and a review of the evidence
of Pages x, 149
Date Added 6/26/2026, 5:10:24 PM
Modified 6/26/2026, 5:10:24 PM

Tags:

Statistics, Prediction, Clinical Psychology

Attachments

- Snapshot

The New Person-Specific Paradigm in Psychology

Item Type Journal Article
Author Peter C.M. Molenaar
Author Cynthia G. Campbell
Abstract Most research methodology in the behavioral sciences employs interindividual analyses, which provide information about the state of affairs of the population. However, as shown by classical mathematical-statistical theorems (the ergodic theorems), such analyses do not provide information for, and cannot be applied at, the level of the individual, except on rare occasions when the processes of interest meet certain stringent conditions. When psychological processes violate these conditions, the interindividual analyses that are now standardly applied have to be replaced by analysis of intraindividual variation in order to obtain valid results. Two illustrations involving analysis of intraindividual variation of personality and emotional processes are given.
Date 2009-04-01
Language EN
Library Catalog SAGE Journals
URL <https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1467-8721.2009.01619.x>
Accessed 9/7/2026, 1:32:54 PM
Volume 18
Publisher SAGE Publications Inc
Pages 112-117
Publication Current Directions in Psychological Science
DOI 10.1111/j.1467-8721.2009.01619.x
Issue 2
Journal Abbr Curr Dir Psychol Sci
ISSN 0963-7214
Date Added 9/7/2026, 1:32:54 PM
Modified 9/7/2026, 1:32:54 PM

Attachments

- Full Text PDF

The ecological fallacy

Item Type Journal Article
Author Steven Piantadosi
Author David P. Byar
Author Sylvan B. Green
Date 1988/05
Language English (US)
Library Catalog pure.johnshopkins.edu
URL <https://pure.johnshopkins.edu/en/publications/the-ecological-fallacy-6/>
Accessed 9/7/2026, 1:29:38 PM
Volume 127
Publisher Oxford University Press
Pages 893-904
Publication American journal of epidemiology
DOI 10.1093/oxfordjournals.aje.a114892
Issue 5
Journal Abbr American journal of epidemiology
ISSN 0002-9262
PMID 3282433
Date Added 9/7/2026, 1:29:38 PM
Modified 9/7/2026, 1:29:38 PM

Attachments

- PubMed entry
- Snapshot

Comparing Effect Sizes in Follow-Up Studies: ROC Area, Cohen's d, and r

Item Type	Journal Article
Author	Marnie E. Rice
Author	Grant T. Harris
Abstract	In order to facilitate comparisons across follow-up studies that have used different measures of effect size, we provide a table of effect size equivalencies for the three most common measures: ROC area (AUC), Cohen's d, and r. We outline why AUC is the preferred measure of predictive or diagnostic accuracy in forensic psychology or psychiatry, and we urge researchers and practitioners to use numbers rather than verbal labels to characterize effect sizes.
Date	2005-10-01
Language	en
Short Title	Comparing Effect Sizes in Follow-Up Studies
Library Catalog	Springer Link
URL	https://doi.org/10.1007/s10979-005-6832-7
Accessed	6/26/2026, 2:40:29 PM
Volume	29
Pages	615-620
Publication	Law and Human Behavior
DOI	10.1007/s10979-005-6832-7
Issue	5
Journal Abbr	Law Hum Behav
ISSN	1573-661X
Date Added	6/26/2026, 2:40:29 PM
Modified	6/26/2026, 2:40:29 PM

Tags:

risk assessment, effect size, predictive accuracy, ROC area

Attachments

- Full Text PDF

Constructing Actuarial Devices for Predicting Recidivism: A Comparison of Methods

Item Type	Journal Article
Author	ERIC SILVER
Author	WILLIAM R. SMITH
Author	STEVEN BANKS
Abstract	A recent contribution to the prediction literature by Steadman et al. features a novel "iterative classification" procedure for constructing risk screening devices. In this article, the authors apply the iterative classification procedure to a large recidivism data set, across a range of recidivism outcomes and cross-validation conditions. The purpose of this study is to assess the generalizability of the iterative classification procedure and to draw comparisons with more traditional methods of device construction. Results show the iterative classification procedure to outperform other standard device construction procedures in terms of the percentage of cases classified as high or low risk but not to outperform more traditional device construction procedures on a variety of other performance measures. Implications for future research on the construction and evaluation of risk screening devices are discussed.
Date	2000-12-01
Language	EN
Short Title	Constructing Actuarial Devices for Predicting Recidivism
Library Catalog	SAGE Journals
URL	https://doi.org/10.1177/0093854800027006004
Accessed	6/26/2026, 2:40:36 PM
Extra	Publisher: SAGE Publications Inc
Volume	27
Pages	733-764
Publication	Criminal Justice and Behavior
DOI	10.1177/0093854800027006004
Issue	6
ISSN	0093-8548
Date Added	6/26/2026, 2:40:36 PM
Modified	6/26/2026, 2:40:36 PM

Attachments

- SAGE PDF Full Text

Predictive Validity Performance Indicators in Violence Risk Assessment: A Methodological Primer

Item Type	Journal Article
Author	Jay P. Singh
Abstract	The predictive validity of violence risk assessments can be divided into two components: calibration and discrimination. The most common performance indicator used to measure the predictive validity of structured risk assessments, the area under the receiver operating characteristic curve (AUC), measures the latter component but not the former. As it does not capture how well a risk assessment tool's predictions of risk agree with actual observed risk, the AUC provides an incomplete portrayal of predictive validity. This primer provides an overview of calibration and discrimination performance indicators that measure global performance, performance in identifying higher-risk groups, and performance in identifying lower-risk groups. It is recommended that future research into the predictive validity of violence risk assessment tools includes a number of performance indicators that measure different facets of predictive validity and that the limitations of reported indicators be routinely explicated. Copyright © 2013 John Wiley & Sons, Ltd.

Date 2013
Language en
Short Title Predictive Validity Performance Indicators in Violence Risk Assessment
Library Catalog Wiley Online Library
URL <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/abs/10.1002/bsl.2052>
Accessed 6/26/2026, 2:40:21 PM
License Copyright © 2013 John Wiley & Sons, Ltd.
Extra _eprint: <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/pdf/10.1002/bsl.2052>
Volume 31
Pages 8-22
Publication Behavioral Sciences & the Law
DOI 10.1002/bsl.2052
Issue 1
ISSN 1099-0798
Date Added 6/26/2026, 2:40:21 PM
Modified 6/26/2026, 2:40:21 PM

Attachments

- Full Text PDF
- Snapshot

A comparative study of violence risk assessment tools: A systematic review and metaregression analysis of 68 studies involving 25,980 participants

Item Type Journal Article
Author Jay P. Singh
Author Martin Grann
Author Seena Fazel
Abstract There are a large number of structured instruments that assist in the assessment of antisocial, violent and sexual risk, and their use appears to be increasing in mental health and criminal justice settings. However, little is known about which commonly used instruments produce the highest rates of predictive validity, and whether overall rates of predictive validity differ by gender, ethnicity, outcome, and other study characteristics. We undertook a systematic review and meta-analysis of nine commonly used risk assessment instruments following PRISMA guidelines. We collected data from 68 studies based on 25,980 participants in 88 independent samples. For 54 of the samples, new tabular data was provided directly by authors. We used four outcome statistics to assess rates of predictive validity, and analyzed sources of heterogeneity using subgroup analysis and metaregression. A tool designed to detect violence risk in juveniles, the Structured Assessment of Violence Risk in Youth (SAVRY), produced the highest rates of predictive validity, while an instrument used to identify adults at risk for general offending, the Level of Service Inventory – Revised (LSI-R), and a personality scale commonly used for the purposes of risk assessment, the Psychopathy Checklist – Revised (PCL-R), produced the lowest. Instruments produced higher rates of predictive validity in older and in predominantly White samples. Risk assessment procedures and guidelines by mental health services and criminal justice systems may need review in light of these findings.
Date 2011-04-01
Short Title A comparative study of violence risk assessment tools
Library Catalog ScienceDirect
URL <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S0272735810001947>
Accessed 6/26/2026, 2:40:44 PM
Volume 31
Pages 499-513
Publication Clinical Psychology Review
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Issue 3
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Tags:

Violence, Crime, Meta-analysis, Risk assessment, Area under curve, Forensic

Attachments

- ScienceDirect Full Text PDF
- ScienceDirect Snapshot

RISK, RACE, AND RECIDIVISM: PREDICTIVE BIAS AND DISPARATE IMPACT*

Item Type Journal Article
Author Jennifer L. Skeem
Author Christopher T. Lowenkamp
Abstract One way to unwind mass incarceration without compromising public safety is to use risk assessment instruments in sentencing and corrections. Although these instruments figure prominently in current r...
Date 2016/11/01
Language en
Short Title RISK, RACE, AND RECIDIVISM
Library Catalog onlinelibrary.wiley.com
URL <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/10.1111/1745-9125.12123>

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Extra Publisher: John Wiley & Sons, Ltd
Volume 54
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Publication Criminology
DOI 10.1111/1745-9125.12123
Issue 4
ISSN 1745-9125
Date Added 6/26/2026, 2:40:16 PM
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Gender, risk assessment, and sanctioning: The cost of treating women like men

Item Type Journal Article
Author Jennifer Skeem
Author John Monahan
Author Christopher Lowenkamp
Abstract Increasingly, jurisdictions across the United States are using risk assessment instruments to scaffold efforts to unwind mass incarceration without compromising public safety. Despite promising results, critics oppose the use of these instruments to inform sentencing and correctional decisions. One argument is that the use of instruments that include gender as a risk factor will discriminate against men in sanctioning. On the basis of a sample of 14,310 federal offenders, we empirically test the predictive fairness of an instrument that omits gender, the Post Conviction Risk Assessment (PCRA). We found that the PCRA strongly predicts arrests for both genders, but overestimates women's likelihood of recidivism. For a given PCRA score, the predicted probability of arrest, which is based on combining both genders, is too high for women. Although gender neutrality is an obviously appealing concept, it may translate into instrument bias and overly harsh sanctions for women. With respect to the moral question of disparate impact, we found that women obtain slightly lower mean scores on the PCRA than men ($d = .32$, 99% CI = $.29-.35$, or 87% overlap in scores); this difference is wholly attributable to men's greater criminal history, a factor already embedded in sentencing guidelines. (PsycInfo Database Record (c) 2025 APA, all rights reserved)
Date 2016
Short Title Gender, risk assessment, and sanctioning
Library Catalog APA PsycNet
Extra Place: US Publisher: Educational Publishing Foundation
Volume 40
Pages 580-593
Publication Law and Human Behavior
DOI 10.1037/lhb0000206
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ISSN 1573-661X
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Tags:

Decision Making, Human Sex Differences, Risk Assessment, Recidivism, Adjudication, Incarceration, Criminal Conviction, Test Bias

Attachments

- Full Text PDF

The Logic of Microaggressions Assumes a Racist Society

Item Type Journal Article
Author Moin Syed
Abstract This commentary draws attention to core assumptions about the nature of society that underlie the current debate on microaggressions. For proponents of microaggression research, the starting assumption is one of a racist society. That is, microaggressions have their source and power within an inequitable, racially stratified society. In contrast, critics of microaggressions begin with the assumption of an equitable society, or at least would not endorse the assumption of a racist society. These two different starting assumptions lead to dramatically different conclusions about the concept of microaggressions. As long as these assumptions are not explicitly recognized, debates on methods, findings, and so on will never be reconciled.
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Library Catalog SAGE Journals
URL <https://doi.org/10.1177/1745691621994263>
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Extra Publisher: SAGE Publications Inc
Volume 16
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DOI 10.1177/1745691621994263
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Journal Abbr Perspect Psychol Sci
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- SAGE PDF Full Text

The Logic of Microaggressions Assumes a Racist Society

Item Type Journal Article
Author Moin Syed
Abstract This commentary draws attention to core assumptions about the nature of society that underlie the current debate on microaggressions. For proponents of microaggression research, the starting assumption is one of a racist society. That is, microaggressions have their source and power within an inequitable, racially stratified society. In contrast, critics of microaggressions begin with the assumption of an equitable society, or at least would not endorse the assumption of a racist society. These two different starting assumptions lead to dramatically different conclusions about the concept of microaggressions. As long as these assumptions are not explicitly recognized, debates on methods, findings, and so on will never be reconciled.
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Library Catalog SAGE Journals
URL <https://doi.org/10.1177/1745691621994263>
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Officials' Estimates of the Incidence of “Actual Innocence” Convictions

Item Type Journal Article
Author Marvin Zalman
Author Brad Smith
Author Angie Kiger
Abstract Evidence indicates that the conviction and imprisonment of factually innocent persons occur with some regularity. Most research focuses on causes, but the incidence of wrongful convictions is an important scientific and policy issue, especially as no official body gathers data on miscarriages of justice. Two methods are available for discovering the incidence of wrongful conviction: (1) enumerating specific cases and (2) having criminal justice experts estimate its incidence. Counts or catalogues of wrongful conviction necessarily undercount its incidence and are subject to accuracy challenges. We surveyed Michigan criminal justice officials, replicating a recent Ohio survey, to obtain an expert estimate of the incidence of wrongful conviction. All groups combined estimated that wrongful convictions occurred at a rate of less than ½ percent in their own jurisdiction and at a rate of 1–3 percent in the United States. Defense lawyers estimate higher rates of wrongful conviction than judges, who estimate higher rates than police officials and prosecutors. These differences may be explained by professional socialization. An overall wrongful conviction estimate of ½ percent extrapolates to about 5,000 wrongful felony convictions and the imprisonment of more than 2,000 innocent persons in the United States every year.
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Extra Publisher: Routledge _eprint: <https://doi.org/10.1080/07418820801954563>
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actual innocence, convictions, estimates, incidence, officials, wrongful conviction

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National Registry of Exonerations

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